



Station Host Protocol

A guide for station hosts facilitating a World Café. Following it consistently is what lets us treat the collected results as data in a scientific study.

// YOUR ROLE

As a station host, you stay with one station throughout the World Café. Your role is to record insights consistently and to moderate the discussion so everyone can take part.

1**Create a welcoming space.**

Set an easy, hospitable tone so people feel safe to think out loud.

2**Ensure everyone can contribute.**

Make room for quieter voices; don't let any one person dominate.

3**Listen to understand.**

Listen for meaning rather than waiting to reply or to correct.

4**Help the group identify patterns and themes.**

Reflect back connections between contributions and invite the group to name them.

5**Remain objective and neutral.**

Keep your own views out of it; treat every position even-handedly. Do not participate in the discussion itself.

6**Facilitate, don't steer.**

Open up the conversation with questions; never nudge it toward a preferred answer.

7**Record collective discoveries on the sheet.**

Capture the group's insights in their words, on the station sheet, as they emerge.

// WHY THIS MATTERS

Hosts provide consistency. They help to transfer knowledge generated during one round to the next round. They also provide consistency in how people can participate.